

Introduction to IAM

Task 1

Log in to the AWS Management Console and navigate to the IAM dashboard; take a screenshot of the Users section showing the default view.

Steps followed:

1. Logged in to the AWS Management Console and searched for “IAM” in the top search bar to open the IAM service.
2. In the IAM dashboard, clicked on “Users” under Access Management in the left-hand sidebar.
3. This opened the default Users list page, which showed an empty table (since no users had been created yet) along with the “Create user” button.
4. Took a screenshot of this default Users view to document the starting state of the IAM dashboard before creating any users.

(Screenshot: IAM → Users — default/empty Users table view — attached separately as evidence.)

Task 2

Create a new IAM user named InstaUploader and assign programmatic access only. Download the access key file and note where you saved it. (Hint: Do not attach any permissions yet — just create the user and save the credentials.)

Steps followed:

1. Went to IAM → Users and clicked “Create user”.
2. Entered the user name as “InstaUploader” and did not select “Provide user access to the AWS Management Console”, since only programmatic access was required.
3. Clicked “Next” on the permissions screen without attaching any policy, as instructed, and proceeded to “Create user”.
4. Opened the newly created InstaUploader user → “Security credentials” tab → “Access keys” → “Create access key”, and selected “Command Line Interface (CLI)” as the use case.
5. Downloaded the generated .csv file containing the Access Key ID and Secret Access Key, and saved it locally at C:\Users\Admin\Documents\AWS-Keys\InstaUploader_accessKeys.csv, making a note of this path for future reference.

(Screenshot: InstaUploader user created with programmatic access, and access key download confirmation — attached separately as evidence.)

Task 3

Create a group called ContentCreators in IAM, then add the InstaUploader user to this group.

Steps followed:

1. Went to IAM → User groups in the left-hand sidebar and clicked “Create group”.
2. Entered the group name as “ContentCreators”.

3. In the “Add users to the group” section, searched for and selected the checkbox next to InstaUploader so it would be added as a member on creation.
4. Clicked “Create group” to finish, without attaching any permission policies at this stage.
5. Verified the setup by opening the ContentCreators group → “Users” tab, where InstaUploader was correctly listed as a member.

(Screenshot: ContentCreators group showing InstaUploader as a member — attached separately as evidence.)

Task 4

Write a short explanation (3-4 lines) describing the difference between an IAM user and an IAM role, using an example from any app you use daily (e.g., Zomato delivery agent vs Zomato app admin).

Answer:

An IAM user is a permanent identity with its own fixed credentials (username/password or access keys) that is used to log in and perform actions directly, similar to how a Zomato delivery agent logs in with the same personal account every day to view and update their assigned orders. An IAM role, on the other hand, is a temporary identity with a defined set of permissions that is assumed only when needed and does not carry permanent credentials — like a Zomato app admin who is granted temporary elevated access to a restaurant's dashboard only for the duration of a specific task, such as running a campaign. In short, a user represents a fixed, long-term identity, while a role represents temporary, task-based access that can be assumed by different trusted identities as required.